

Clinical Policy: Outpatient MRI Neuro-Imaging (CPT 70551)

Effective Date: January 15, 2026.

Prior authorization is strictly required for all non-emergency outpatient MRI scans of the brain.

Documentation must demonstrate that the patient has experienced chronic headaches for > 4 weeks and failed at least one conservative medication trial (e.g., NSAIDs) for minimum 14 days,

OR exhibits focal neurological deficits on clinical exam.

Failure to obtain pre-authorization will result in an absolute administrative denial with zero provider appeal rights.